



SOLAR SYSTEM

FAR FROM HARDWAR where the Maha Kumbh paused during the solar eclipse, a tribal explains the occurrence to villagers in Upper Kanti, Orrisa. After the January 15 eclipse, the next total solar eclipse will take place 104 years later on June 3, 2114.

MUMBAI | Silent Nights

Bursting firecrackers or playing loud music at night will get the noisy into serious trouble. Under a new law, bursting of firecrackers, playing loud music and using construction machinery in residential areas between 10 p.m. and 6 a.m. can attract imprisonment up to seven years or a fine of Rs 1 lakh. The permitted level for any sound emitting instrument is 10 decibels at public places and 5 decibels at private places. The Ministry of Environment and Forests is also setting up a network for national-level monitoring and reporting of noise pollution, managed by the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) and state pollution control boards. "The network will monitor noise pollution levels and create a database. This will enable law enforcing agencies to take concrete action against those that flout the rules," says S.P. Gautam, chairman, CPCB. *by Harsha Bhat*



LOUD NOISES IN RESIDENTIAL AREAS AT NIGHT ARE SET TO BE BANNED WITH THE GUILTY BEING FINED OR JAILED.